

Document Description

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Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Policy

Our Commitment to Diversity, Equity and Inclusion

Aligned Automation is committed to fostering a culture of diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) where every individual feels valued, respected, and has an equal opportunity to thrive and succeed. Our dedication to DEI enhances our ability to address complex challenges in the industry and to better understand and meet the diverse needs of our clients. We see ourselves as agents of positive change in our communities and in our value chain, with the aim to create a more equitable world through our continued efforts.

Our commitment to DEI is a dynamic journey of continuous improvement. We regularly assess our initiatives, seek input from our employees and stakeholders, and refine our strategies to drive meaningful progress. Our employees are powerful change agents actively shaping an inclusive workplace that celebrates diversity and ensures equity.

Scope

This policy applies to all of Aligned Automation's internal and external stakeholders across our own operations and our value chain and outlines our commitment to an inclusive, diverse and safe workplace.

Equal Employment Opportunity

Aligned Automation provides equal employment opportunities to all employees and applicants without regard to race, color, religion, gender, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability, or any other protected characteristic. In addition, the company complies with applicable state and local laws governing non-discrimination in employment in every location in which the company has facilities. This policy applies to all terms and conditions of employment.

Inclusive Work Environment

We are committed to creating a workplace where everyone feels empowered to innovate and succeed. We strongly promote a culture of respect and value for diversity and are unwavering in our commitment to eradicate any form of discrimination and harassment in our workplace.

Non-Discrimination

Aligned Automation strictly prohibits discrimination against any employee or job applicant based on race, color, religion, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability, or any other protected characteristic. We are committed to providing equal employment opportunities and treating all individuals with fairness and respect.

Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes unwelcome or unwanted conduct of a sexual nature. It is difficult to define all conduct which may constitute sexual harassment in violation of this policy. However, Aligned Automation has provided below examples of behaviour which violate this policy and constitute sexual harassment

- Coerced sexual acts (which may also result in criminal liability)
- Express or implied demands for sexual favours or dates in exchange for favourable reviews, assignments, promotions, continued employment or promises of continued employment
- Unwanted sexual advances or verbal commentary about an individual's body or sexuality
- Sexually coloured remarks or jokes
- Suggestive, insulting, or obscene comments or gestures
- Display of graphic and sexually suggestive objects, pictures, or graffiti in the workplace

Any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature. The type of behaviour described above is unacceptable not only in the workplace, but also in other work-related settings such as business trips or business-related social events.

We hold annual awareness sessions on the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) policy. We

have an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), composed of both internal and external members, to address sexual harassment against women at the workplace. Any concerns or complaints can be directed via email at posh@alignedautomation.com

Anti-Harassment

We maintain a zero-tolerance policy towards harassment in any form. Harassment is also verbal or physical conduct that degrades or shows hostility or aversion towards an individual because of an employee race, colour, creed, religion, gender, national origin, marital status, age, disability, sexual orientation, or other protected status, or that of persons with whom the individual works.

Recruitment

Aligned Automation is committed to creating a fair and accessible recruitment process that fosters diversity, equity, and inclusion. All candidates are provided with equal opportunities and hiring decisions are solely based on merit, skills, qualifications, and experience. We promote diverse talent pools, utilize inclusive job advertisements, and provide necessary accommodations for candidates with disabilities.

Career Progression

We evaluate candidates for promotion solely based on their qualifications and contributions, without regard to personal characteristics unrelated to job performance. We maintain transparency in our promotion processes by communicating criteria and expectations to all employees. We provide mentoring and career development opportunities to facilitate professional growth.

We implement a structured approach to employee performance assessment, conducting annual evaluations and quarterly recognition programs. We establish SMART goals at the beginning of each fiscal year or during onboarding to ensure a consistent and equitable method for measuring performance.

Diversity in Leadership

Diversity in leadership, encompassing age, gender, ethnicity, and physical abilities, is a strategic business imperative. A leadership team that reflects this diversity brings together a wealth of perspectives, experiences, and skills. This diversity fosters innovative solutions and enhances decision-making processes. It also enables us to effectively understand and cater to the diverse needs of our customer base.

Professional Development and Training

Aligned Automation provides ongoing training and professional development opportunities to help employees develop cultural competency, awareness, and sensitivity. Our programs cover a range of topics, including soft skills, technical expertise, industry knowledge, and cross-functional training. We also encourage employees to participate in DEI initiatives to support their growth and help create a more inclusive workplace.

Women Development

Aligned Automation is committed to supporting the development and advancement of women in our organization. We provide equal opportunities, tailored mentorship, and leadership programs to empower women in their professional growth, enhancing gender diversity and promoting a more inclusive workplace for all.

Wage Equity

Aligned Automation is steadfast in its commitment to wage equality. We conduct regular pay equity analysis, maintain transparent compensation practices, and ensure equal pay for equal work. To promote fair and equitable compensation, we conduct periodic salary reviews and educate our employees on wage equality principles. We believe that fair compensation is essential to our commitment to diversity, equity, and inclusion.

Accessibility and Accommodations

Aligned Automation is committed to creating an accessible workplace for all employees, including those with disabilities. We provide reasonable accommodations to ensure that employees with disabilities can perform their job duties effectively.

Supplier Diversity

We are committed to partnering with diverse suppliers and vendors, including minority-owned and women-owned businesses, to support economic development and diversity in our communities.

Employee Resource Groups (ERGs)

Aligned Automation supports the formation of Employee Resource Groups (ERGs), which serve as protected environments for employees to connect, exchange experiences, and actively engage in our initiatives related to Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI).

Reporting and Accountability

Aligned Automation will regularly assess and measure our progress toward DEI goals and objectives. We encourage employees to report any incidents of discrimination, harassment, or bias, and we will promptly investigate and address such concerns.

Review and Compliance

Aligned Automation is dedicated to the ongoing review and compliance of our Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) policy. We regularly assess the impact of our DEI initiatives, solicit feedback from our employees, and ensure alignment with relevant laws and regulations. Our commitment to training and education, coupled with accessible reporting mechanisms and accountability measures, reinforces our pledge to maintain an inclusive workplace culture that evolves to meet the changing needs and expectations of our diverse workforce and communities.

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Date: